HOLY TRINITY UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF PRACTICAL THEOLOGY

DEPARTMENT OF ETHICS AND SPIRITUALITY

SOCIAL ETHICS

SENIOR LECTURER

FASIL ASMAMAW

Course Title	**Social Ethics**
Course Code	401
Credit Hours	3
COURSE INSTRUCTOR	Mhr. Fasil Asmamaw Zewdu (Doctor Of Education Candidate Strategy Leadership And Educational Policy and Masers Of Inclusive Education, Masters Of Practical Theology)
Department and Semester	**Holy Trinity Theological University** **Faculty Of Practical Theology** **Department Of Ethics And Orthodox Spirituality, Year 4, Semester 1**
Course Description	To explain the real orthodox family and marriage To elaborate the real orthodox family and marriage To experience The Real Orthodox Family And Marriage
Course Objective	The course note and the reading documents will be provided in advance. Students are strongly encouraged to read the documents thoroughly, and expected to come to the class with a summary of the specific text own critical views and reflective comments are contained.
Course Content	**TABLE OF CONTENT** **CHAPTER ONE** **1. The Definition of Social Ethics** **1.1. What is social ethics?** **1.2. Types of Ethical Principles**

	1.3. Components of social ethics **1.4. Characteristics of social ethics** **1.5. Universal ethical-social principles** **CHAPTER TWO** **2. WHAT IS ORTHODOXY MARRIAGE?** **2.1. Foundation of Marriage** **2.2. The Meaning of Marriage** **2.3. The Purpose of Marriage** **2.4. The Responsibilities of Husband** **2.5. The Responsibilities of Wife** **2.6. The Mutual Responsibilities of Spouse** **2.7. Nuclear Family and Extended Family** **2.8. Pre marriage** **2.9. Perimarrage Resolving problems in Marriage** **2.10. Post Marriage Counseling** **2.10.1. Divorce** **CHAPTER THREE** **3. Introduction: Nature of Social Institutions** **3.1 Definitions and Meaning of Institutions**

	3.2 Characteristics of Institutions **3.3 Importance of Institutions** **3.4 Institutions and Associations** **3.5 Institutions and Customs** **3.6 Introduction** **3.7 Family: its Etymology and Definition** **3.8 Different kinds of family systems** **3.8.1 Family of orientation or procreation** **3.8.2 Neo-local, Patri-local or Matri-local System of Family** **3.8.3 Family as monogamous or polygamous** **3.8.4 Family as patriarchal and matriarchal** **3.9 Distinctive features of family organization** **3.10 Functions of the family** **3.11 Types of family** **3.12 Future of the family as an Institution**
Reading List	***ON MARRIGE AND FAMILY BY SAINT JHON CHRSTOSOM***
Grading System:	96-100 = A+;

	90-95 = A; 85-89 = A-; 80-84 = B+; 75-79 = B; 70-74= B-; 60-69 = C; 50-59 = D; 49 – F.
I. Methods of delivery	✓ Teacher presentation-kick-off assessment approaches ✓ Independent learning - readings, reporting, reflections etc ✓ Preparation of seminar papers and presentation ✓ Critique and systematic reviews on research article, ✓ Seminar papers ✓ Empirical Study - Analysis Project ✓ Participation in paper presentation and making sound comments
II. Type of Exam and Result	Result will be given based on student's class participation and interactive discussion on the reading documents, and of course the final exam. Students will be provided list of questions related to each topic discussed in the class to study and prepare them for the exam. On the exam day, the student will choose four or five questions out of the list and give the answer in a separate paper.

	Attendance ……..10 Individual Assignment ……20% Group Assignment And Filed Work……..…...20% Mid Exam ……..……..20% Final Exam …….....30%

CHAPTER ONE

Dear Disciples, this chapter discuss about the following social ethics issues

Objectives

- **To define the concept of social ethics**
- **To identify the types ,components ,characteristics of social ethics and the universal ethical-social principles**

1. The Definition of Social Ethics

1.1. What is social ethics?

1.2. Types of Ethical Principles

1.3. Components of social ethics

1.4. Characteristics of social ethics

1.5. Universal ethical-social principles

1.1. What is social ethics?

Social ethics is a concept that deals with the moral conduct of individuals as well as their collective reality and the combination of their individualities. It's about all the standards of behavior that people have to be able to live peacefully with others, respecting the physical and moral integrity of oneself and others. That is, it is about those socially desirable behaviors that should be carried out in a society so that it is a good space for coexistence in which to live.

Social Ethics

Social ethics is a branch of ethics that examines how moral principles apply to social interactions and collective structures. Unlike individual ethics, which focuses on personal morality, social ethics is concerned with the norms that guide group and organizational behavior, seeking a balance between individual rights and collective welfare.

The idea of social ethics is complex, since it implies establish what are the appropriate actions and behaviors that all people should carry out or avoid doing within a given society. Although it is legitimate for everyone to think about their own good, it is necessary to have empathy and respect for others, since if we did not do so, everyone would think selfishly, behaving too freely. The excessive freedom of one can be the prison of another.

Although the idea of social ethics is based on the fundamental principle of respecting the rights of others so that one's own rights are respected, it is worth noting that everyone understands differently what is socially appropriate. Thus, social ethics can vary, since it varies depending on the ability of people in a society to see to what extent their actions imply consequences at a social level.

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1. Deontological ethics

This ethical principle is based on the belief that morality is derived from duties and obligations. According to deontological ethics, actions are judged as right or wrong based on whether they adhere to a set of moral rules or principles.

2. Utilitarianism

Social Ethics

This ethical principle is based on the belief that the best decisions are those that produce the greatest happiness or pleasure for the greatest number of people.

3.Virtue ethics

This ethical principle is based on the belief that moral behavior should be guided by the cultivation of virtuous character traits such as compassion, honesty, and integrity.

The importance of Ethical behavior in society cannot be overemphasized. Ethical behavior promotes trust, respect, and accountability among members of a community. It also helps to prevent harm and injustice to vulnerable members of society. Without ethical behavior, society would not function effectively, and there would be widespread social, economic, and political instability.

Common ethical issues and dilemmas that individuals and organizations often face include conflicts of interest, privacy, confidentiality, discrimination, and corruption. These issues are often complex and require careful consideration and ethical analysis to determine the best course of action.

In professional life, ethical principles and values are particularly relevant in business, healthcare, technology, education, and governance. Ethical behavior among professionals helps to promote integrity, trust, and social responsibility.

Developing an ethical framework is essential for making ethical decisions. Some guidelines for ethical decision-making include:

1. Identify the problem or situation.
2. Gather and analyze relevant information.
3. Consider different ethical perspectives and principles.
4. Identify and evaluate the options available.
5. Make a decision and take action.
6. Reflect on the decision and evaluate the outcome.

In conclusion, social ethics is a critical aspect of human society that promotes responsible behavior and accountability. Understanding ethical principles and values is essential for making sound decisions and promoting social justice and equity. By approaching ethical issues and dilemmas with care and thoughtfulness, we can build a better and more just society for all.

1.2. Types of Ethical Principles

In social ethics, there are several types of ethical principles that guide and define what is considered to be morally right or wrong. Here are some of the main ethical principles that you need to know

1. Utilitarianism:

This ethical principle states that the right action is the one that creates the greatest amount of happiness for the greatest number of people. It focuses on the consequences of actions and seeks to maximize positive outcomes for society as a whole.

2. Deontological Ethics:

This ethical principle focuses on the inherent morality of actions, rather than the outcomes. It emphasizes the importance of following principles, rules, and duties, regardless of their consequences.

3. Virtue Ethics:

This ethical principle focuses on developing morally sound character traits, such as courage, honest, and compassion, and using them to guide ethical decision-making. It emphasizes the importance of becoming a good person rather than simply performing good actions.

4. Moral Relativism:

This ethical principle asserts that there are no universal moral truths or values, and that ethical principles are culturally and socially determined. It emphasizes the importance of understanding and respecting diverse cultural perspectives.

5. Social Contract Theory:

This ethical principle asserts that ethical principles are based on an implicit agreement between people to form a society and cooperate for mutual benefit. It emphasizes the importance of upholding social norms and laws in order to maintain social order.

1.3. Components of social ethics

According to the German philosopher Georg Wilhelm Friedrich Hegel, social ethics is made up of three components: the family, society and the State.

1. The family

The family is the first human group with which we have contact, and it is through it that we acquire different types of values including those of a social nature.

It is within the family where norms are instilled that regulate the behavior of its members, both towards the rest of the family and with the community. It is a fundamental environment where values are learned such as not harming others, respecting other people's opinions, respecting other people's property, sharing…

Clearly each family has its own educational style and therefore their idea of what is socially ethical varies. It is based on these differences that will condition its members to adapt and be respectful more easily with the ethical norms of society.

2. The society

Social Ethics

Society is the human group, of macroscopic size, that is responsible for creating the norms and laws that support what is considered socially ethical. That is, the society of each region, country or culture in the world It is the one in charge of deciding what is considered socially accepted behavior and what is not.

This may depend on various aspects such as culture, religion, historical context and previous events. For example, what was socially ethical in the United States at the beginning of the 20th century was very different from today if we talk, for example, about respecting people regardless of their race.

3. The state

The state is responsible for applying and enforcing social ethics shared by the majority of a society Although not all social norms have to be typified in the criminal code, many of them, such as respect for life by criminalizing murder or the defense of private property by punishing theft, have ethically based laws.

It is thanks to the State that it is possible to protect individuals as a whole, preventing everyone from doing whatever they want without questioning the ethics of their actions. That is, it is through the application of justice that social ethics are protected and enforced, offering rights and imposing obligations on all individuals in society.

Rights and Responsibilities

One key component of social ethics is the balance between individual rights and responsibilities toward others. While rights protect personal freedoms and dignity, responsibilities remind us of the need to act in ways that benefit society as a whole.

Justice

Justice is fundamental in social ethics, ensuring that all people are treated fairly. This includes equal opportunities, fairness in the distribution of resources, and access to legal justice. Social justice aims to correct inequalities and promote an inclusive environment.

1.4. Characteristics of social ethics

Among the main characteristics of social ethics we find the following.

Regulates human behavior

Social ethics, both imposed through state laws and accepted by society as a whole in the form of socially imposed norms, regulate human behavior.

It involves everything that should be done and what should not be done to have a good coexistence, which **makes people behave the way society requires us to**

Create universal principles

Socially ethical norms become universal principles, with a reduced degree of flexibility and very difficult to break, given their social and criminal consequences.

Yes ok **Breaking a universal principle is not synonymous with committing a crime** doing so can put the individual in a very bad position in front of the rest of society, losing impact or seeing their status in society jeopardized.

An example of a universal principle whose violation does not imply legal consequences is that of greeting. Although trivial, not greeting other people can be seen as an antisocial act that, although it has no legal implications, can cause the rest of society to reject the individual who does not follow the universal principle.

A clear example of a socially ethical principle that, if broken, implies legal action is the principle of not killing. This is universal to the extent that it is accepted by the majority of individuals in a society and shared from culture to culture. Failure to respect it implies not only rejection by society, but also the application of legal penalties.

It is the implementation of values

Each person has values, which depend on the family and the society in which they live. **Actions in favor of social benefit from an ethical-social perspective are, in essence, the implementation of these values.**

For example, if we have the courage to not harm others, we can put it into practice not only respecting the lives of others, but also helping them and doing our best to benefit others.

Coercion is not accepted

The idea of social ethics establishes that **prosocial actions must be done voluntarily.** That is, no one should be forced to carry out actions beneficial to others, but rather it should come from within: he or she should be the one who has the will and initiative to help the most disadvantaged, get involved in social causes, contribute to progress of the society…

Collective

Unlike personal ethics, social ethics has a **collective** focus as it concerns group dynamics and how individual actions affect society as a whole.

Governed by Social Norms

Social ethics is based on **social norms** that vary depending on the culture and context. These norms reflect a community's shared values and set the limits of acceptable behavior.

Dynamic

Social ethics is **dynamic** and changes over time, adapting to new realities and challenges that society faces. What may have been considered ethically acceptable at one time may be reevaluated and changed based on collective needs and aspirations.

Related to Politics and Economics

Social ethics is inherently connected to a society's **political** and **economic** systems. Public policies and economic decisions are often influenced by ethical principles that aim to promote equity, justice, and collective well-being.

1.5. Universal ethical-social principles

Although each culture is different, it is true that many ethical-social principles are universal. Below we will see a few that are either only accepted at a social level or, in addition, have laws that regulate them.

1. Respect and care for nature

Nature must be respected and conserved so that all human beings can continue living healthily.

If we abuse animal and plant species and do not protect the environment, we run the risk of it deteriorating, causing food shortages and social problems such as poverty, ethnic conflicts and wars for control of resources.

Although many states have laws that prohibit polluting or exploiting some animal and plant resources, the truth is that this principle is not as universal as others.

2. Be kind and generous with others

Being kind to others is a universal principle that, although it is not penalized, it is **It is considered a necessary prosocial behavior to be considered a well-adjusted individual in society.**

3. Respect for institutions and current legislation

Although this principle may be controversial, given that **The current legality of a state does not have to be socially just.** Yes, it is true that respect for the law is a universal principle.

It is because if the laws are not complied with, everyone could do whatever they want, and in many of these laws there are ethical-social values that, although desirable, are only respected when there is a law that prohibits behaving in a manner transgressive towards that value.

4. Respect the rights of other people

Based on the principle that if we want to be respected we must respect others. **We all have rights and obligations.** And if someone disrespects us, most states have laws to make sure they are punished accordingly.

5. Respect freedom of thought

Nobody is the same, much less thinks the same way. Everyone has had experiences that influence their way of perceiving the world, so each person has their own thoughts.

Freedom of thought is considered a universal principle at least in Western countries, since not respecting it is considered, in most cases, a violation of human rights.

However, this principle has its limits, since if the opinion implies intolerance or harm to other people, two other principles are being violated, that is, being tolerant of human diversity and not harming others.

6. Do not steal or murder

Although these are two different principles, they have in common that **most countries view robbery and murder as crimes.** From this it can be deduced that the principles

of respecting the property of others and the lives of others are universally recognized ethical-social values, and that violating them implies serious legal sanctions.

1.6. Examples of Social Ethics in Action

Gender Equality

The fight for **gender equality** is a clear example of how ethical principles are applied in the social sphere. This movement seeks to ensure that men and women have the same rights and opportunities, challenging social structures that perpetuate discrimination and inequality.

Environmental Protection

The growing concern for **environmental sustainability** reflects social ethics recognizing our collective responsibility to protect the planet for future generations. Individual and collective actions, such as reducing waste or using renewable energy, are examples of ethical actions motivated by these principles.

Human Rights

Human rights are another crucial example of social ethics in action. These universal norms seek to ensure that all individuals, regardless of their background or condition, are treated with dignity and respect. Promoting and protecting these rights is a shared responsibility of individuals, governments, and organizations.

Economic Justice

The fight for more **economic justice** is a manifestation of social ethics. Policies that aim to reduce poverty, ensure fair wages, and provide access to basic resources like education and healthcare are based on ethical principles that prioritize collective well-being.

Social ethics is essential for maintaining a just, equitable, and harmonious society. Through promoting principles like justice, solidarity, tolerance, and respect for human dignity, we can work together to solve collective problems and improve the quality of

life for all members of society. Reflecting on these principles and applying them in our daily decisions is key to building a more inclusive and just future.

How do social ethics influence political decision-making?

Social ethics influences political decision-making by providing a moral framework for evaluating policies and laws. Political leaders must consider how their decisions affect the collective well-being and whether they promote justice and equity.

What is the relationship between social ethics and economic justice?

Economic justice is a key component of social ethics, as it seeks to ensure that resources and opportunities are distributed fairly among all members of society. Social ethics promotes equity and fights against poverty and inequality.

How can solidarity be encouraged in society?

Solidarity can be encouraged by promoting empathy and mutual support, recognizing that one person’s well-being is connected to that of others. Community initiatives, volunteering, and inclusive policies are examples of how solidarity can be strengthened.

What role do human rights play in social ethics?

Human rights are fundamental to social ethics, as they guarantee the protection of the dignity and basic rights of all individuals. Promoting these rights is essential for building a just and equitable society.

How has social ethics changed over time?

Social ethics has changed over time in response to social, economic, and political challenges. The evolution of civil rights, gender equality, and environmental sustainability are examples of how social ethics adapts to new realities.

CHAPTER TWO

Dear Disciples, this chapter discuss about the following orthodox marriage issues

Objectives

- **To define the concept of social ethics of Marriage**
- **To identify the types ,components ,characteristics of social ethics and MARRIAGE ISSUES**

2. WHAT IS ORTHODOXY MARRIAGE?

2.1. Foundation of Marriage

2.2. The Meaning of Marriage

2.3. The Purpose of Marriage

2.4. The Responsibilities of Husband

2.5. The Responsibilities of Wife

2.6. The Mutual Responsibilities of Spouse

2.7. Nuclear Family and Extended Family

2.8. Pre marriage

2.9. Perimarrage Resolving problems in Marriage

2.10. Post Marriage Counseling

2.10.1. Divorce

1. WHAT IS ORTHODOXY?

The term Orthodoxy consists of two words: "orthos"(true, right) and "doxa". "Doxa" means, on the one hand, belief, faith, teaching and on the other, praise or doxology. These two meanings are closely connected. The true teaching about God incorporates the true praise of God; for if God is abstract, then prayer to this God is abstract as well. If God is personal then prayer assumes a personal character. God has revealed the true faith, the true teaching. Thus we say that the teaching about God and all matters associated with a person's salvation are the Revelation of God and not man's discovery.

2.1. Foundation of Marriage

Marriage is founded by God Himself Gen 2:18-24 Mt 19:3-6. It is the plan of God. Foundation matters. All the manuals of the marriage come from the founder Who is God as anybody prepares manual for the materials he founded. By saying God is a founder of marriage we are saying that we must look and obey all the orders of marriage that God intended for. There are so many corruptions in relation to marriage. We have to look to the founder and His principles to overcome all the problems. This must be a mirror to evaluate all marriages.

2.2. The Meaning of Marriage

Marriage is a life time organization that one man and one woman being united and become one flesh by leaving their parents to live to the same goal Gen 2:24. 1. Life time is to show that marriage is until to death Rom 7:1-3. Separation is not allowed by any means except death. We cannot provide any other excuse for divorce. 2. One man and one woman shows opposite sex Gen 2:24. Again this verse said a

man united with his wife. So it shows clearly an ordened plan of God for marriage is a man with a woman. The same sex is impossible by any means. In different countries the same sex marriage is exercising including Ethiopia. Even this same sex marriage is exercised first in Anglican Church. I heard an Evangelist said that he will not tell to his daughter not to have sexual intercourse with the opposite sex but he tells her not to have sexual intercourse with the same sex. He said this after he heard about the expansion of the same sex sexual immorality. 3. Being united and one flesh show that both are united to be one in holistic life like purpose and goal Gen 2:23.

4. Leaving parents shows that the first place companion or kin is one another, that they will have their own home administration and that they will be mature enough Gen 2:24. We all must have to see if the above meaning is in our marriage and in others' marriage. 1.3. The Purpose of the Marriage Purpose is the reason to exist. When we say the purpose of marriage we are saying why marriage exists. Many forces in society are undermining the Biblical concept of the marriage. Today there so many people who are marrying for the purposes like money, sexual intercourse, and other earthly reasons. God a founder of marriage does have a serious purpose for marriage. A creator of marriage knows its purpose. 1. To the glory of God 1Cor 10:31. When the couples reflect the image of God towards one another by unconditional love, holy life and others, God will be glorified. Parties should have the image of God to glorify Him Gen 1:27. 2. To multiply and to bear godly offspring Gen 1:28 Ps 127:3 128:3 Jer 29:6 Tit 1:6. God will ask us if we don't do all possible our responsibilities to our cildren. We are responsible to help them to grow godly. Is that proper to use contraceptives for not to give birth to a child in marriage? or to limit the number of children? How do you see? 3. To show the practical relationship of Christ and church Eph 5:21- 25. What kind of relationship

is there between Christ and the Church? Relationship that between Christ and church should be exercised between husband and wife. Christ and church do have the same purposed relationship which is Gospel. Christ is the head of the church and he loved the church in cross, and the church should submit to Christ. Husband is to be servant leader of his wife and he has to love his wife as Christ loved the church. And wife should submit to her husband's biblical leadership. The husband wife relationship does not show husband's subduing and wife's submitting but mutual life and their job description because they have the same purpose and goal. Christian's marriage is a marriage that couples live from the same faith point of view in Christ. Both have the same faith and living style which is Christlike 1Cor 7:39. They should live heavenly life on earth. Christians marriage is be model to the world marriage. Because our marriage is to be shaped in the image of God. True love, true fellowship, monogamy, marriage without divorce and all true marital life is to be found in Christians marriage.

4. To Be one flesh Gen 2:24. When the verse says both become one flesh, it has meaning more of sexual relation. The word flesh shows that the whole humanity and life of a person. It talks about the oneness of both. They are united to have the same purpose. They are to be one in will, speech, thought, spirit, practice, purpose, and goal

2.4. THE RESPONSIBILITIES OF HUSBAND

- Being servant leader of his wife Eph 5:23.

- Loving his wife as Christ loved the Church Eph 5:25. This love is shown in Greek as unconditionally seeking the welfare of another person and meeting his or her needs.

- Submitting to her Eph 5:21.

- Not being harsh to her Col 3:19.

- Considering her gender weakness 1Pet 3:7. • Respecting her 1Pet 3:7

- Not deceiving her at all Mil 2:14-15 1.5. The Responsibilities of Wife • Helping her husband by fitting him Gen 2:18, 20.

- Submitting to her husband's biblical leadership Gen 3:16 Eph 5:21-22 1Pet 3:1, 6. • Having good conduct towards her husband 1Pet 3:1-2.

- Not adoring outward beauty 1Pet 3:3. Today's women are known by adoring the outward like fashioned clothe, massage, pouring oils and hair fashion.

- Being the man of heart 1Pet 3:4

- Loving her husband Tit 2:4.

- Loving her children Tit 2:4. Today some women are throwing children after they gave birth. • Being self-controlled Tit 2:5.

- Respecting her husband 1Pet 3:5.

- Fearing God Prov 31:30. 1.6. The Mutual Responsibilities of Spouse

- Submitting one another Eph 5:21.

- Loving one another practically. Love is practical. It cannot be expressed only by saying I love you. Let us practice practical love one another. • Doing own job description. They don't need to indicate one another when the problem happens among them but they should do their own job description and then the problem will be easily solved.

- Having Biblical and positive attitude towards one another in relation to personality, education, wealth and property.

- Giving time one another. Some marriages are terminated because of busy life of one another.

- Sharing feelings and ideas one another like heir fear, joy, mistakes, vision and others.

- Being unselfish. A fundamental requirement of a good marriage is a willingness to give self for the good of other. - Knowing both have equal personality. One flesh shows that they are in similar position. In some culture a husband is so greater than wife. I strongly believe that both have equal personality. She has to submit to her husband and He has to love his wife as Christ loved the church which is until to the death Eph 5:21-33. Loving her as Christ loved the church is so dynamic. Even it seems more than submitting but both have equal personally for they are created in the image of God Gen 1:27.

- Being clear one another. Don't hide anything.

- Respecting each other

1.7. PREMARAGE COUNSELING

1. Communication

2. Conflict resolution

3. Money use

4. Parenting styles

5. Family issues

6. Sexual issues- premarital issues

7. Ethnicity issues

8. Friends issues

9. Personal and family timing

1.8. PERI MARRIGE COUNSELING

There are two types of family nuclear and extended. 1.8.1. Nuclear family members are father, mother, and children or brother and sister.

1.8.2. Extended family members are grandfather, grandmother, uncle, aunt and others related kins. When we talk about family we are talking especially about the nuclear family such as father, mother and sons who are living together.

1.9. The Responsibilities of the family

1. Worshipping God Josh 24:15. Family is the main worship center Josh 24:15. Praying, studying the word of God and singing together. At least once a week the worship program must be in the family. The practicing point is that every one of us must have the worship program at home even if we are alone. Our program must be contently. Our home must be as church to worship God 1Cor 16:19. House of Aquila and Priscilla was church and a place of worship. Our home must be God glorified and worshipped. 2. Being guided only by the word of God to all their lives Gen 19:19 Deu 6:6-9 2Tim 3:15-17. Their supervisor is the Bible. They should be guided by the Word of God. They have to lead their marriage through the principles of Bible. 3. Providing and caring one another 1Tim 5:8. We are responsible and have responsibility to our family

1.10. POST MARRIGE COUNSELING

1.10.1. DIVORCE

Marriage is not seen today as a sacred, unbreakable bond. People prefer living separately than ―suffering together‖. So divorce is no more a ‗no‘ in our society today. When a married couple cannot get along due to some reasons they decide to terminate the marriage. Termination of marriage is called divorce. Even in primitive societies, divorce was common. They were divorced for barrenness, negligence of children, invalidism, old age, disagreeable personality etc. The economic value of the wife and the husband in the primitive society helped to limit the frequency of divorce. The economic factor was much stronger. The breaking of the family is therefore, a concern of the society. Family may dissolve as a consequence of separation, desertion or divorce. It is said desertion is a poor man‘s divorce as it is common in the poorer groups. Causes for divorce: Numbers of explanations have been given for the marked increase of divorce, especially in countries like U.S.A., Russell says as the family feeling is very weak, there is frequency of divorce. For example, in France and India, divorce will be comparatively rare even if it is easy. Adultery, cruelty and desertion may not be more prevalent today than sixty years ago. It is possible that the loosening of the social taboo and the easing of convictions have given many couples the courage to come out in the open and end their incompatibility with a legal divorce. Some of the factors that have led to the increase in divorce are:

1) Industrialization:

It has liberated women from economic dependence on men and given them an equal status so neither of them must marry, nor stay married to solve their economic problems. Because of this, it has probably had the consequence of

allowing family differences to be magnified out of proportion to the real significance. Industrialization does not cause a divorce, but does weaken the emotions that often bind family together in spite of difficulties.

2) Equality and individualism –

A psychological explanation for an increased rate of divorce is a strong feeling of individualism. This has reached against the virtue of tolerance, give and take attitude required in the family relationships. Female emancipation has boosted the woman‘s ego and helped to destroy the paternal type of the family. The feminist movement has made her more self-assertive and thus endangered the old type of family stability.

3) The position of the father in the family –

Russell insists that the modern father is losing his form of position in the society. The father is busy earning a living and some of them scarcely see their children and when he sees them, he hardly knows how to behave with them. This is true both among the upper classes where family instability seems to be most marked and among the lower classes where poverty does not permit the father to be much of a parent. Among the middle class at present, the father is of utmost importance as long as he earns a good income and can provide adequately for his offspring.

4) Childlessness –

A large proportion of persons going in for a divorce, in the American society are childless. The presence of a child in the family generally gives a married couple a strong purpose that stabilizes their relationship. Once a couple becomes a parent, they are able to keep their ego aside and there is a bond which ties them together. It has been noted that in certain cases, the presence of children has helped in the

reconciliation of some divorced couples. In fact, 70% of childless marriages ultimately end up in a divorce.

5) Infidelity –

Another vital factor frequently overlooked is that we have standards of strict sexual morality and hence infidelity is commonly regarded as the greatest hurdle and the wrong partner in the family usually feels that both pride and decency require a divorce action. In countries like France, fidelity is not considered the most important factor for the success of marriage. Adultery is not likely to provoke the husband or wife to file a petition for divorce.

6) Lack of sex education –

By and large, it has been seen that most marriages that end in divorce are due to sexual incompatibility. People often marry without proper understanding of their sexual roles in marriage. Therefore, today the urgent need is a proper and so called correct understanding of sex.

7) Divorce varies with occupation –

Certain occupations assert more strain on the family life than the other occupation. Certain occupations presuppose more temperament than the other and attract the emotional tie. Other occupations where the husband is away from the house for a longer or shorter period may lead to a break-up in the family. Divorce is high among artists, physicians, musicians etc. This merely reflects the effect of the occupation on family life with the resulting degree of instability. 8) Divorce seems to reach its maximum about the fifth year of marriage. It is said that if a couple can pull on for five years, the chances for the continuous success of marriage are greatly increased. This is due to the fact that family requires an immense amount of

readjustment and each party to the contract must learn to get used to the matrimonial state. In an economic system within which it is difficult for a young man or woman to undertake the responsibility of a wife or husband before 25 years of age and by then habits become settled and readjustment to new relations is made with increasing difficulty. Some other causes of divorce are uncontrollable interference such as parental intrusion, (wide differences in education and religion between the partners, serious personality defects and personal disappointments) result in the breaking of marriage. Effects on children:

• The issue of the custody of children is most delicate. If it is resolved properly then children do not suffer.

• If situation not handled properly, children may develop insecurity.

• If handled with care children may develop to be responsible _caring' independent. Legal status:

• Divorce has to be granted by the law authority. In India, it is granted only after using all other means to reconcile (like counseling, Arbitration etc.) fail. Divorce may be granted only under very specific conditions. 1. Write in brief about Single Parent Family 2. State the main causes for adoption. 3. State the importance of surrogacy in the present context. 4. State the causes of divorce and its effect on children.

Social Ethics

Questions 1. Write a note on Marriage as a social institution.

2. Write in brief about Sacrament theory of marriage and contractual theory of marriage.

3. State the different trends of marriage in modern society.

4. Do you feel that Single parent family satisfies the emotional and social needs of a child? Give reasons.

5. Give reasons for divorce and its effect on children.

6. Write a note on Surrogacy.

Fasil Asmamaw Zewdu (Senior Lecturer) Department Of Ethics And Spirituality

CHAPTER THREE

Dear Disciples, this chapter discuss about the following Family issues

Objectives

- **To define the concept of social ethics OF FAMILY**
- **To identify the types ,components ,characteristics of social ethics and the family and Family as a Social Institution**

3. Nature of Social Institutions

3.1 Definitions and Meaning of Institutions

3.2 Characteristics of Institutions

3.3 Importance of Institutions

3.4 Institutions and Associations

3.5 Institutions and Customs

3.6 Introduction

3.7 Family: its Etymology and Definition

3.8 Different kinds of family systems

3.8.1 Family of orientation or procreation

3.8.2 Neo-local, Patri-local or Matri-local System of Family

3.8.3 Family as monogamous or polygamous

3.8.4 Family as patriarchal and matriarchal

3.9 Distinctive features of family organization

3.10 Functions of the family

3.11 Types of family

3.12 Future of the family as an Institution

3. Introduction: Nature of Social Institution

3.1 Definitions and Meaning of Institutions

Institutions are usually defined as ‗certain enduring' and accepted form of governing the relations between individuals and groups. Different sociologists have offered different definitions for institution. According to Ellwood, institutions are ‗habitual' ways of living together, which have been sanctioned and established by communities. Mackenzie defines institution as a definite organization pursuing some specific way. According to Bogardus defines social institution as a structure of society that is organized to meet the needs of people chiefly through well-established procedures. Good word and Maxwell state that an institution is a network of folkways and mores that center on the achievement of human and all purposes. It is evident from the above definitions that an institution has some definite aims by virtue of which it benefits to the society. Institution is only an organized form of racial customs, dogmas and rituals or methods.

3.2 CHARACTERISTICS OF INSTITUTIONS

The following are the characteristics of Institutions: 1. Every institution has some definite objectives. 2. There is a symbol of an institution, which can be material and non-material. 3. Every institution has some rules, which must be compulsorily obeyed by individuals. 4. It has definite procedures, which are formulated on the basis of customs and dogmas. 5. Institution depends upon the collective or group activities of man. 6. Institutions are means of controlling individual. They are more

stable than other means of social control. Institutions are formed for the fulfillment of the primary needs of an individual. 3.3 IMPORTANCE OF INSTITUTIONS

In connection with the social importance of institution Mac Iver says: it is a means of transferring cultural elements from one generation to another. It introduces unity in socialbehavior, controls, conducts and guides men of all circumstances. In a society, moral ideals or modes of behavior are transferred from one generation to another though the medium of an institution. Thus it helps the younger generation to solve the problems confronting it.

3.4 INSTITUTIONS AND ASSOCIATIONS

An institution differs from an association in the following grounds: institutions are comprised of laws and systems; but associations are composed of human beings. Associations have a concrete form but institutions are abstract. Institutions evolve while associations are formed. Associations lack the stability of institutions. An institution is a procedure of working while an association is an organized group. An institution indicates procedure of works and association – shows membership. Therefore, man is a member of association but not of an institution. 26

3.5 INSTITUTIONS AND CUSTOMS

The concept of institution is very similar to custom. A custom is a habitual way of behavior, which is followed in a society, for example, to queue up at a bus stand. Owing to the closeness that exists between habit and custom, custom has been defined as a _sanctioned habit‘. Habit is an individual way of doing things whereas custom is a group act. From this it may be easily seen that the difference between custom and the institution is a matter of degree. An institution being socially normative is more impersonal and less spontaneous than custom. So in modern

society the institution of marriage is more formal than the custom of courtship. Hence, institution is more widely recognized and held as necessary for society than custom. Thus the family may do away with courtship but not with marriage. An institution is expected to concern itself with the deeper needs of social life. Therefore association is an affiliation, institutions are infrastructures and customs are ways of doing things as sanctioned by society.

3.6. INTRODUCTION

The family is by far the most important primary group in the society. Family is not a mere association but an institution. Historically, it has been transformed from a more or less self – contained unity into a definite and limited organization of minimum size consisting primarily of the original contracting parties.

That the family is ‗Natural' to a man is almost sufficiently apparent from the fact that it is natural to most of the highly developed animals. The family therefore is a socially recognized unit of people related to each other by kinship, marital and legal ties. In most societies it is normally constituted of a married pair and their children, parents of the husband or the wife and in some societies even servants are admitted as the members of the household.

3.7 FAMILY: ITS ETYMOLOGY AND DEFINITION

The word ‗Family' is taken from the Roman/Latin word ‗famulus' which means a domestic slave and familia primarily meant a collection of slaves attached to a household. Later the family came to mean not only the slave but also the persons included within the regular household – all regarded more or less as the property of

the family. It is no doubt true that we have seized to think of a man‘s family as his slave. Every society implies the ultimate control over this unit by its institutionalization of marriage and the definition of rights and obligations that arise as a result of marriage and subsequent reproduction. Thus Mac Iver and page define family as, ―A group defined by sex relationship sufficiently precise and enduring to provide for the procreation and upbringing of children. From the definition the following characteristics follow.

1. It is a mating relationship.

2. This relationship is maintained through the form of marriage and other institutional arrangement.

3. The need to make the necessary economic provisions associated with childbearing and child rearing, is shared by the members of the group.

4. The members share a common habitation, home, a household, which however may not be exclusive to the family group. These characteristics are so universal as to see them essential to the very nature of the family.

Check Your Progress

1. State the origin of the word _Family‘.

2. Name any two characteristics of family.

3.8 DIFFERENT KINDS OF FAMILY SYSTEMS

3.8.1 Family of Orientation or Procreation:

Each individual usually holds membership of two families during his / her life : the family in which one is born and the family in which one marries. The family in which one is born is called the family of orientation and that in which one marries is the family of procreation also called the family of appropriation. The family of orientation socializes the individual, provides for his economic and social needs and gives him a pace in the society. Membership in this family is involuntary for one cannot choose the family to which one is to be born. One‘s position in this group is unchangeable whereas in the family of procreation the individual has children of his own and has the responsibility of providing for them. In order to 28 establish the family of procreation one or both the partners have to leave the family of orientation.

1.8.2 Neo-local, Patriarchal or Matriarchal System of Family: In some of the western countries they follow the neo-local system where the married couple establishes a home apart from both the families of orientation. This however is not the most common arrangement. In other societies some follow the Patrilocal system in which the wife leaves the family of orientation towards the husband‘s family of orientation. Yet some others follow the Matri-local system where the husband leaves the family of orientation towards the wife‘s family of orientation. The place of residence has a considerable influence on the functioning of the family of orientation whereas the family of appropriation is the part of the Patri or Matri-local system; the activities of the husband or the wife may be subjected to parental control. The advantage is that it may assist the newly married in getting established.

3.8.3 Family as Monogamous or Polygamous:

The family may be Monogamous or Polygamous. The former is constituted of a man and woman living together and the latter either of a man living together with more than one woman or vis-à-vis.

3.8.4 Family as Patriarchal and Matriarchal:

If the head of a family is a male then it is called a patriarchal family and when the authority is in the hands of the female then it is called matriarchal family. Patriarchal families are more common and in contrast, in matriarchal or mother-right family, the authority of the family and the ownership of property would be in the hands of the Mother. The transmission of name and rights could be done through the oldest female that goes from the mother to the oldest daughter and even the place of residence is matriarchal. Further, in some cases, it is the husband who goes to reside with his wife and the children also belong to the mother‘s clan. Matriarchal families are found among the Keralites, in some of the communities in Assam, and in the west it prevails among the North Americans.

1. State the origin of the word ‗Family‘.

2. Name any two characteristics of family. 3. Bring out the difference between Patri-local and Matri-local system of Family.

3.9 DISTINCTIVE FEATURES OF FAMILY ORGANISATION

The family is the most universal social group of all the organizations large and small, which the society enfolds. Family has an intense sociological influence. It is in many respects unlike any other association. It has several distinctive features:

1. Universality: No culture or society has ever existed without some form of family organization. As B. Malinowski writes, ―the typical family, a group

consisting of mother, father and their progeny, is found in all communities-savage, barbarian and civilized. Every human being is or has been a member of some family or other‖.

2. Emotional Basis: It is based on the most profound urges like mating, procreation, maternal instincts and parental care. Besides this there are other reasons like the wish to transmit one‘s name and property to posterity, the need for economic security and cooperation to guarantee help and friendship for the future of a person‘s life especially during old age and to have a partner in life with whom one can share the joys and sorrows, success and failure.

3. Formative Influence: The family moulds the character of the individual by inculcating in their minds the ideal base and custom of the social group. For instance – the purpose of family is to educate children. It exists largely for the nurture of young children and to prepare them to face the larger community.

4. Limited Size: It is the smallest group of all formalized organizations that make up the social structure in any civilization. 5. Social Regulations: Family is well protected by social taboos and legal regulations. Marriage, property, inheritance etc. are common institutions of a family organization respected by all. 6. Responsibility: It makes continuous and greater demands on its members than any other association. In times of crisis, men may work and fight for their country, but they toil for their families all their lives. It expects sacrifice and a sense of duty from the members of the family as they have a common interest and collective goals. 7. Both Permanent and Temporary: It has a temporary as well as permanent nature. As a basic institution, which is domestic, it is permanent, as it is found in every society. It is an irony that while the institution of family is so permanent and

universal, the family as an association is the most temporary since each family artificially comes into existence and may

3.10. FUNCTIONS OF THE FAMILY

According to Grover, Family is an organization for protection, growth and care of the young, the regulation and the control of the sex impulses, transmission of social heritage and opportunities for the most intimate relations. A modern family performs various functions, mainly of which are due to the impact of social and economic functions acting upon a family. The main functions of the family are as follows:

1. Biological function :

   The family is the only recognized social unit for the protection of children. All the societal forces are used for its protection and through it societies perpetuate themselves both biologically and culturally. As per Mackenzie, the most fundamental function of the family is primarily to secure what is best available for the nurture of the children with a view to their preparation as citizens of a larger community.

2. Socializing function :

   The rights and duties in a family bind the parents to each other in matters beyond the marital obligations. They also bind parents to the children beyond the provision of primary needs and the children to the parents at least for aid in case of need. Thus the family emerges as a social institution. The behavior of its members expressing socially prescribed forms of actions, thus the family does by the use of parental authority and parental affection.

Until the children accept right privileges and obligations not as demand and deprivations but as opportunities and self imposed responsibilities.

3. Subsistence Function :

   Family provides subsistence for its members in a congenial environment. The basic instinctive needs such as hunger, thirst, shelter, love care, protections etc. are provided in and through the family. In other words, the family provides all that is needed for survival, growth and experience. No other institutional pattern can provide daily care and personal attention that families can give by their home making nor can they do it in the intimate ways,

which is so significant in personality building. Family housekeeping provides necessary nutrition, a sanitary abode, a warm and cozy place for relaxation, personal attention to sickness and other requirements. Ralph Litton has written that mere satisfaction of bodily needs is not sufficient for the proper development of children. They are in greater need of individual attention, love and satisfaction of life.

4. Economic function :

   The life of the family has an important economic aspect. In the past, the responsibilities for making provisions for the economic needs of family usually depended on father and the mother remained busy in managing the house and taking care of needs of members. In most of the cases the father did earning, and distribution and management were done by both the parents. But, due to the shift in the economic settings of the family following the industrial revolution, slowly, the high standards of living, increasing wants, consumerism, desire for luxury and comfort have made it necessary

for both partners to shoulder the economic needs of the family. 5. Educational Functions :

The family is the natural center of primary education. It is an important agency, which prepares an individual for a vocation. In the past boys received their training for life by working with their fathers and girls got trained at home. It is still an important educational agency, which prepares the family members to specialize. The family has given the school the task of preparing the youth for adult life; but the school cannot replace the home, as home is the social and affectional center of the child‘s life. One can say that school supplements the family by providing the knowledge and experience, which the latter cannot give. John Dewey, Madame Montessori, Pestalozzy regard the fact that the family is the best educational institution ever. And no college or school can every really take its place.

5. Cultural Function :
6. The family is the first institution to get the opportunity to transmit the ideas, beliefs and values of the society to the growing child. It serves as a natural and a convenient channel of social continuity.

7. Moral and Religious Functions : The children gather their basic religious ideas and beliefs from the family through functions like marriage, celebration of festivals and other religious ceremonies. Nowadays, parents nolonger place a greater emphasis on religious education neither is it ignored. The family is the school of moral education. The members of the family imbibe the social virtues of sympathy, fellow feeling, love and co-operation, the spirit of self-sacrifice and tolerance. These sentiments are the basis of all other social sentiments and virtues. 8. Legal Function : A child is

born into a family and when it becomes an adult he accepts responsibilities and duties befitting his position in the family and society. The parents take on the responsibilities and duties befitting his position in the family and society. The parents take on the responsibilities and duties as long as child is a minor. Once he attains majority he can marry even without his parents‘ consent and has the right to vote. All the above functions lend stability to society and allows for continuity in a disciplined way. To sum up, the vital functions that family has to play cannot be substituted through any other institution. Biologically the human child is born dependent and some kind of parental relationship is necessary for the child to survive. His emotional needs are observed to be as urgent as his need of food. To survive in a large world the child has to learn what is expected of him. Here the family serves as a cultural mediator. Thus, some kind of institutionalized family group is found in all societies and is fundamental to the social system.

3.11 TYPES OF FAMILY

Families take diverse form in different times and places. Their attributes have changed greatly during the past 150 years or so. Joint or extended family and nuclear family are the two types. A. Joint Family

1. Origin of the Joint Family :

   The primitive social group originated from patriarchal family, in which the father held the greatest power and owned all the members and belongings of the family. In the next stage of social evolution the patriarchal family became the joint family. In its original form the joint family consisted of the aggregate of individuals who were members of the family. During that stage the members of the joint family were not necessarily related by blood. But in course of time a joint family referred

to only those persons who were born in it or who became its members by affiliation or marriage

According to D.F. Mullah Points out that a Hindu Joint Family consists of all such persons who have lineally descended from a common ancestor and include their wives and unmarried daughters.

2. Characteristics of Joint Family :

The joint family system was prevalent from the Vedic times in the Hindu Society. The members of joint family owned property jointly, a common kitchen and a common deity. According to Prof. D. F. Mullah, the possession of a joint property is not a necessary factor for the formation of a joint family, for a person becomes a member of the joint family by birth. But as this system evolved in the society, the possession of joint property became a necessary condition for keeping the members tied down to a family. Hari Singh points out that importance and strength of a joint family consists in the fact that all the members own its properties in common. It can also be said that it is the joint property, which keeps the members together. It is in this sense that, sometimes, joint family is compared to a corporation.

3.Its Internal Organization :

The internal organization of the joint family is much more valued and more significant than the composition of the nuclear family. The valuation is not only in size but also in role configuration making up the system. The members of the joint family may belong to the following four categories.

1. Persons descended from a common ancestor to the extent of four generations. 2. Collateral relations descended from a common ancestor in a male line like uncles, aunts, nephews, cousins and so on.

3. Persons adopted in the family e.g. adopted sons daughters etc.

4. The mothers, wives, widows and unmarried daughters of the male members of the joint family.

2.2 Management of Property and Authority in Joint Families:

In the joint family, property plays a very important role. At one time it was a binding factor and management of property was in the hands of the head of the joint family, who was called a ―Karta‖ – He has certain special rights and control over the joint family income and also decides the way in which family income should be spent. When the joint family property is divided / distributed each member gets his / her appropriate share. In the division of authority between men and women the male plays a major role and is the focus of power whereas women play a subordinate role. Seniority determines who will have authority among the adult males. Between the father and the sons the principle of seniority is easily established. The older member always has a higher rank. When the father dies the eldest brother succeeds to this position. Joint Family makes the ‗authority‘ of the individuals submissive to that of the head. The authority of a father over his own children is subordinate to the overall authority of the eldest male. This is important because it discourages the crystallization of the nuclear family with the dominant power as a separate union. While seniority is the general determinant of authority, however, the authority cannot be used arbitrarily. The eldest male must confirm to specific family and cast traditions. Tradition is an important force in all family-

systems. 2.1 Filial Relationships in the Joint Family : In the joint family the conjugal relationship is important. But it has always been subordinate to the requirements of the larger system. Filial relationships i.e. mother-child or father-child relationship or between brothers are more emphasized for the stability of the joint family. The mother-child relationship was emotionally restricted by the norms of impartiality between many children in the joint family though this is not so today in the joint family. Traditionally the mother is regarded as the one who is concerned about the property interest of her children and wishes to protect them against possible exploitation by the uncles and the cousins. Therefore the child may find a more gratifying relationship with his / her mother than with his father. The relationship to the father is close but it is still one of respect. The fraternal relationship is usually a close one but constrained. The structural source of constraint may arise from status differentiation: it means brothers age factor matters. This can bea potent source of jealousy and rivalry. The relationship between the brother and sister is significant. For the young growing boy and even for the grown up, the sister is not a potential rival and she can become a source of feminine tenderness? While the brother – brother relationship may be very close it rarely approaches the tenderness of brother – sister relationship. This problem arises from the fact that the men belong to joint family and women are outsiders. 2.4 Status of women in joint family: The cardinal position of men determines an important status of their wives and affects the attitude of women towards each other in the Joint family. But an equally important determinant of the wife‘s status is her closeness to her husband. He can be her 35 spokesman and facilitate her acceptance in the household. But where the relationship is not close she must still lean heavily upon him for understanding and support. From this comes the pattern of dependence and subordination of women. Child upbringing is not the exclusive responsibility of the individual mother but the physical dependence of the child on

the mother for its nourishment binds the mother to the child. This relationship has a great emotional significance and often becomes a source of strain for the relationship between a mother and the wife of her adult son. One of the common problems of a man in the joint family is the conflict of loyalties – the loyalty to his mother to whom he owes too much and to his new wife whom he may not yet know, but who is his concern and who must inevitably lean upon him for support. In the nuclear family this problem is not unknown but is minimized by a more definite norm of loyalty to one‘s wife. The mother‘s status is also socially gratifying for the women especially when she has given birth to a male child. The male child assures continuity of a family lineage and the mother achieves status as the person who has given birth to this child. The failure of the women to give birth to a male child is one of the approved reasons for her husband to bring a second wife into the home. There is another reason why the mother‘s role, particularly the role of the mother for the son, is important for a woman. Formally the woman had to right in the property of husband‘s family. If the husband dies leaving her widow she could expect maintenance but she would always feel that she is dependent. The son thus confirms her status as the member of the family and provides an insurance against the possibility of laws of status due to widowhood.

3. Advantages joint family:

In its traditional form the Joint Family provided a kind of social security for its members; for no one was wholly dependent on his own resources. And in case of any misfortune befalling on a member of the family, all the members shared it. They always had a feeling that they would be looked after with care and affection. Even if the head of the Joint Family died, other surviving members of the family looked after his widow and children.

4. Disadvantages joint family:

A joint family often becomes unmanageable due to large number members within the family. Thus some members were uncared and neglected. The women were the most sufferers in the family. Another major disadvantage was that a joint family often gave rise to idlers (parasites) who feed on the income of other 36 earning members without contributing anything, thus becoming a burden for the active members of the family. Finally it was seen that children of the head of the family received preferential treat whereas children of the junior members were neglected. These were some of the factors that led to the disintegration of the system. 5. Causes for Disintegration of the Joint Family: The joint family system is fast breaking down in almost all the countries and the same is even seen in India especially in cities. The disintegration has certain inevitable historical events. Some of the main causes for the disintegration may be briefly stated: Commercialization: Increasing commercialization, introduction of cash and individualization adversely affected the joint family. The destruction of village community and the breakdown of the traditional social structure as a result of modernization affected the structure and value system of the Joint Family, the production of the market, the payment of land revenue in cash and the substitution of the collective principle for the individual cultivator. Responsibility for the payment of land revenue generated a centrifugal tendency, which gave a severe jolt to the joint family system.

6. Concept of Private Property: The introduction of the principle of the private property in land transformed land into marketable commodity. Land could now be mortgaged, purchased and disposed off by an individual cultivator. Under the increased burden of land revenue and a competitive market economy a vast number of cultivators were forced to sell their lands to money lenders and this led

to the fragmentation of joint family. 3. Uniform Legal System: An introduction of a uniform legal system based on a secular rational and egalitarian principle led to the dissolution of the joint family. A legal recognition of an individual‘s right to own and dispose of family property, the right to claim a share in ancestor‘s property, the freedom to choose any vocation, the fixation of the principle of individual responsibility and the uniform legal code contributed to the breakup of the joint family.

4. Social Reforms: (Especially emancipation of Women) :

Under the impact of the modern educational system and the westernization process, social reformers initiated a movement for the emancipation of women for their education for a reform of the traditional social structure. The prohibition of child marriage and the promotion of widow remarriage disturbed the functioning of the joint family. 5. Competitive Society: Lack of sympathy and fellow feeling was more apparent in a competitive society where in each individual has to struggle hard for earning his livelihood. Those who were enterprising earn more and those who lack initiative and tact earn less. This led to frequent quarrels and tensions among the family members and as a result the joint family broke into smaller family units. 6. Lack of Freedom: It is usually found that the head of the joint family (Karta) tends to be dominating and authoritarian in his attitude and place restrictions upon his junior members. With the onset of industrialization the old traditional ideas and values changed. The junior members did not appreciate and accept the dominating attitudes of the senior members and rebelled against the seniors. A joint family breaks down when these are frequent and serious clashes between the junior and senior members. 7. Commerce and Industry: Commerce and Industry brought income and property to the individuals and not only to the group. In general the legal institutions of the western powertended to individualize.

The foreign powers recognized individual ownerships and placed demands such as taxation and labour service upon individuals. Employment was on individual basis. These economic and legal factors were indirectly responsible to weaken joint family systems. 8. Changing Position of Women: In a joint family, women generally had no rights of inheritance or independence of action. As the idea of the emancipation of women spread around the world, it brought restlessness within the joint family structure. The movement for equal rights for women paved the way for their equality before the law and rights of inheritance as well as opportunity for education and right to vote. 9. Rapid Social Change: The joint family structure was weakened by rapid social change, which tended to undermine the authority of the elders. Young people were acquiring new standards and the body of knowledge, which were at variance with the knowledge, and values of elders. It was no longer easy to maintain filial loyalty and respect in the traditional set up. 10. Urbanization: The movement of individual members of the joint family to the cities tended to erode the joint family. Urban housing with its small dwellings and crowded conditions made it difficult to accommodate an extended family group. 11. World War II: All these factors tend to undermine the joint family but it was the World War II and its effects that dealt a direct blow to this traditional system. The breaking up of the joint family was accelerated by taxation, inheritance laws and laws of the rights 38 to women. Although joint families have been able to partition their joint property the new system of taxation and inheritance place pressure on families to convert themselves into small, single, family units. B. Modern Family (Nuclear Family) Modern India, is also offered and affected by many of the changes originating in the west especially technology, growth of scientific knowledge and effectiveness of communication. Hence the Indian family is feeling the effect of these changes. Owing to the migration of people from the villages to cities from small towns to metros, the traditional joint family is

disintegrating all over the world thereby creating a number of psychological economic and social problems of growing importance. In a research conducted by Ms. G.A. Hate about the position in Mumbai, she found that only 33% of the married women interviewed belong to a joint family,

Defects of Modern family and Break Down of Nuclear Family:

1. In the post war period of 20th century marriage is no longer taken as a religious sacrament. The element of moral obligation and sense of responsibility is no longer taken seriously. It is treated more as a contract which like any other contract can be 39 called off or broken either by individual will or by mutual agreement. As a result the moment any strife, discontent or a mistake occurs on either side the partners being to think in terms of divorce. The movement any one of the spouses fails to appeal or attract the other sexually it results in divorce. The concepts of personal priority, personal freedom and permissiveness are major causes of disintegration of the family. With divorce laws being lax and procedure to obtain divorce made very easy, it is giving rise to increase in divorce rates in modern families thereby leading to the breakdown of modern nuclear family.

2. In present times the degree of literacy and higher education has gone up both among men and women. Women have acquired equal status with men and have larger financial independence. This concept of equality has been accepted by men in principle though not in practice. Therefore both partners expect great independence, unrestricted freedom, non-interference and voluntary participation in the activities and careers of their choice. This equality factor is mistaken for complete and total freedom with very little accountability. Thus lack of tolerance and cooperation has weakened the family unit.

3. In the 20th century, industrialization and urbanization, mass media communication quick and easy transport has made for greater mobility.

This has changed the practice of family life. Therefore most members in most families live together with very little concern or time for others. The house today has become more of a hostel or hotel accommodation, where family members come and go at their own convenience, eat when they are hungry, rest when they are tired, but have a common address without having anything else in common among each other.

4. The generation gap

We talk about only signifies the conflict between parents and children as they hold different views on things in general. This generation gap has been partly responsible for the disintegration of family life. The relationship between parents and children has weakened. This is mainly because the transmission of moral, social and cultural values has been neglected. The old moral values are being destroyed by the younger generation without it being replaced by new better values. This causes a vacuum in the life of the younger generation and leads them astray. This implies that the first duty of the parents is to undertake responsible parenthood and the first duty of the younger generation is to accept them as their well-wishers.

5. In a very free permissive society the younger generation indulges freely in premarital sex and also extra-marital relationships.

In 40 such societies they fail in love at first sight and separate out at the first fight. The sense of responsibility no longer exists. But other serious setbacks of a sexually permissive society are sexual diseases of various kinds. This has given

rise to the rapid spread of AIDS for which there is no cure to date. It has given rise to many sociological and psychological problems. It shakes up the very foundation of institution of marriage.

7. A large number of modern women have opted for a career in order to meet the growing financial needs of modern times and to be self-reliant. They have the required educational qualification to back them through their careers. This in turn has given rise to neglect of children and home to a certain extent. Consequently there has been an increase in juvenile delinquency; many children run away from homes or drop out from schools. They in turn become mal-adjusted spouses in their married life and this cycle of deterioration of family goes on.

3.12 Future of the Family as an Institution

1. Introduction:

Few social problems are more solemnly discussed than that of the future of the human family.

A Pessimistic view:

A pessimistic view predicts that family will ultimately disappear. According to them, the family seems to have lost much of its former unity and its central position in the life of an individual, the economic and social interdependence of its members, many of its loyalties, common interest, common amusement and common traditions. We no longer have big families, and in small ones, each member is an individual with his or her own interest, activities, circle of friends and frequently his or her own income. The home has been called a place where one goes when he has no other engagements. Of course it is a bit far-fetched but it‘s a long cry from

the old family unit and the unity that exists in the family today. The smaller unity has been exchanged for the larger and new loyalty has taken the place of the old. The family was formally a self-sustaining social and economic unit. The family produced goods that the family consumed. In this modern world of large – scale factories one or more members of the family earn salaries with which new goods are purchased where formally these goods were produced at home. Today the modern commercialization could supply the demand better than the home can. Thus the pessimists emphasize the exceedingly high rate of family breakdown, the overemphasis upon the individual and his rights to complete freedom, the unwillingness of parents to assume responsibilities with regard to each other and their children, the loss of many functions that help to bind the family members to each other and their children and the lack of any effective public concern to assist families in trouble.

8. This reasoning suggests that the family as an institution is approaching a crisis that will lead to a collapse. But even if this should prove to be true, it will not take place for many generations to come. According to Anderson and Linderman, the extinction of human family at some distance date in the future, is obviously a purely academic question, but immediate future tendencies in the family are a matter of real practical concern. The increased prevalence of urban life and living conditions associated with it are likely to place great importance upon the mother. A woman‘s biological function remains constant for no changes in a cultural and social set up will ever alter the biological factor that woman must bear the children whatever the degree / type of social change affecting the family. On the other hand, the father‘s influence in the family has been considerably lessened by recent culture and social changes. Moreover social workers have pointed out that keeping the

mother and child together is a far more important matter than keeping the father present in the family. It is quite possible that the state will step in and take over many of the father‘s responsibility in supporting the mother and the child. This argument denies the position of the father both financially and emotional and this is a very far-fetched explanation). This state provides for the education of the child, public health amenities, child guidance clinics, recreational centers and many other child welfare bodies and many other forms of aids, which were formally a domestic responsibility. The permanent family under male parental domination owed its enduring equalities primarily to the fact that these were indispensable responsibilities, which the family alone could supply to the child. 3. An Optimistic View: On the other hand an optimistic view recognizes the rapid changes that this institution has experienced during recent decades and its consequent instability and weakness. There are evidences of a transitional stage in which the family is moving to a firmer base that assures greater permanence and stability because of firmer relationships among its members. These optimists argue that entrance into marriage primarily on an affectional basis, the reduction of economic pressures and the voluntary bearing and rearing of children would appear in the long run to provide the soundest foundation for an enduring family and resources for its own stability. If civilization survives the present world crisis such as war, drug menace, AIDS, modernization, we may safely predict that the family may be greatly modified but that marriage will continue to be popular as ever, through undoubtedly readjusted in terms of social rationality. Affection will play a large role in keeping the family together than sheer economic pressures. Influences, which increase affection such as children, mutual interest, avoidance of excessive intimacy and life will need to be stressed and

encouraged. Supernaturalism, intolerance, ignorance and dogma will have a lessening authority and influence over family life. Sex and parental instincts can find their gratification in the most natural, normal and decent form within the family. Outside the family such basic motives cannot be satisfied : if at all they are satisfied they are neither normal nor psychologically healthy. Outside the family there can be neither legal offspring nor can there be ideal arrangement for its upbringing. Therefore, the system of marriage may change in future, but the family will continue to exist as permanent and as the most enduring institution as long as society exists. Mutual affection, love, co-operation, sacrifice and respect within the family guard against many of the mental and physical problems of a complicated society. The family life will have to be reconstructed through readjustment involving sex education, the sanction and encouragement of compassionate marriage and imposition of greater restrictions and responsibilities upon permanent unions, rational divorce legislations and the provision of economic conditions, which will bestow upon the family the material foundation for an enduring and successful matrimonial arrangement. The family of the future will be kept together because the parties wish to have the marriage endeavoured and because the family is worth preserving. Marriage is primarily fulfillment of duties.

The basic aim of marriage is protection and shelter to all family members. 4. Conclusion To conclude, in the words of Burgers and Locke, ―It seems to predict that family will survive, both because of its long history of adaptability to changing conditions and also because of the importance of its functions of affection, giving and receiving in personal satisfaction and in personality development.

Social Ethics

SUMMARY QUESTIONS

1. Bring out the distinctive feature of family as an organization.

2. Does the concept of _WE‘ becomes important in the family? State your views.

3. In what way does a family contribute to the economic and social growth of an individual? Explain

4. The moral and social values play an important role in the structuring of an individual. State how it is performed by family.

5. Describe the criterion to be followed to be a member of joint family?

6. What is the status of women in joint family?

7. State how the modern system of family has changed from the traditional perspective of family. 8. Do you think that the family as an institution will survive in the future?

2. QUESTIONS: Essays:

1. Explain the nature of family as a social organization? 3. Discuss the role played by the family as an institution in the modern times. 4. 2. Define family and explain the major functions of family.

5. 3. Bring out the origin and essential features of joint family system. State and explain the factors that led to the disintegration of the joint family. 6. 4. Distinguish between the joint and nuclear family with reference to its advantages and disadvantages. 7. 5. Explain the nature and types of family. What is the future of family as an institution? 8. 6. Explain the various functions of the family in the modern times. Can the society dispense with this institution? 9. 7. ―In the changing social situation, the future of family as a social institution is gloomy.‖ Explain it with reference to the functions of family.

10. 8. ―Whatever gloomy pictures social scientists may depict, future of family is not so dark.‖ Comment.

Social Ethics

Fasil Asmamaw Zewdu (Senior Lecturer) Department Of Ethics And Spirituality